

1. Compute $\frac{d}{dx} \arctan(x^3 + 1/x)$.

Solution. We use the chain rule:

$$\frac{d}{dx} \arctan(x^3 + 1/x) = \frac{1}{1 + (x^3 + 1/x)^2} \cdot (3x^2 - 1/x^2).$$

2. Compute $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^7 - 1}{x^4 - 1}$.

Solution. Since plugging in $x = 1$ gives a zero in the numerator and denominator, we're looking at an indeterminate form of type 0/0 and can use l'Hôpital's rule:

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{x^7 - 1}{x^4 - 1} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{7x^6}{4x^3} = \frac{7}{4}.$$

3. Compute $\int x^2 \sin(2x) dx$.

Solution. We integrate by parts, taking $u = x^2$ and $dv = \sin(2x)$ to get $du = 2x$ and $v = -(1/2) \cos(2x)$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \int x^2 \sin(2x) dx &= -\frac{1}{2} x^2 \cos(2x) - \int 2x \cdot \left(-\frac{1}{2} \cos(2x)\right) dx \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} x^2 \cos(2x) + \int x \cos(2x) dx, \end{aligned}$$

and we can integrate by parts a second time. This time, $u = x$ and $dv = \cos(2x)$ gives us $du = 1$ and $v = (1/2) \sin(2x)$ for

$$\begin{aligned} \int x^2 \sin(2x) dx &= -\frac{1}{2} x^2 \cos(2x) + \int x \cos(2x) dx \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} x^2 \cos(2x) + \frac{1}{2} x \sin(2x) - \int \frac{1}{2} \sin(2x) dx \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} x^2 \cos(2x) + \frac{1}{2} x \sin(2x) + \frac{1}{4} \cos(2x). \end{aligned}$$

4. Compute $\int \frac{1}{(\sqrt{1-x^2})^3} dx$.

Solution. We see a $\sqrt{1-x^2}$, and this is our signal to try a trig substitution. We set $x = \sin(\theta)$ and get $dx = \cos(\theta) d\theta$. Plugging everything in and integrating gives

$$\begin{aligned} \int \frac{1}{(\sqrt{1-x^2})^3} dx &= \int \frac{1}{(\sqrt{1-\sin^2(\theta)})^3} \cdot \cos(\theta) d\theta \\ &= \int \frac{\cos(\theta)}{(\sqrt{\cos^2(\theta)})^3} d\theta = \int \frac{\cos(\theta)}{\cos^3(\theta)} d\theta \\ &= \int \frac{1}{\cos^2(\theta)} d\theta = \int \sec^2(\theta) d\theta = \tan(\theta) + C \end{aligned}$$

And then we need to rewrite this in terms of x . From our substitution, $\sin(\theta) = x/1$, so we set up a right triangle with angle θ , where the side opposite θ is x and hypotenuse 1. We're looking for $\tan(\theta)$, so we also need to know the adjacent side. The Pythagorean theorem gives $\sqrt{1-x^2}$, so $\tan(\theta)$ being opposite over adjacent gives $x/\sqrt{1-x^2}$. That is,

$$\int \frac{1}{(\sqrt{1-x^2})^3} dx = \tan(\theta) + C = \frac{x}{\sqrt{1-x^2}} + C.$$